

India's electronics market to reach US\$ 1 trillion by 2028: IESA

According to India Electronics and Semiconductor Association (IESA), the country's electronics market will reach a turnover of US\$ 1 trillion by 2028, following the growth in domestic production of mobile handsets. "India's electronics market is expected to reach US\$ 600 billion by 2026 and US\$ 1 trillion by 2028 as per revised figures submitted to the government," Anil Kumar Muniswamy, chairman, IESA, was quoted by *Economic Times*. He added, "There will be massive opportunity in the 5G era as well as everything will move to the cloud."

Indian PCB market to cross US\$ 5.35 billion by 2023

The PCB market in India is projected to grow at a CAGR of 17.7 per cent during 2018-2023, and cross US\$ 5.35 billion by 2023, according to a report by Research and Markets. Citing reasons for such growth, the report said that in the last few years, demand for PCBs in the country has recorded a steady growth due to favourable government initiatives and rising investments in digitisation. The Indian PCB market was valued at US\$ 2.02 billion in 2017, the report said.

MeitY seeks proposals to support local R&D for EV sub-systems

To promote the local production of EV sub-systems, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) has sought permission to set up an 18-month R&D project, which will be partially funded by the Central government. Keeping in view the technological requirements of EVs and to increase the level of locally-manufactured content, a short-term R&D programme is also being initiated by MeitY. This programme will impact areas such as motors, controllers and converters, for electric two-wheelers and three-wheeler e-rickshaws. This initiative is expected

to deliver sub-systems to indigenous EVs at a lower cost and also contribute to Make in India initiative, a MeitY official informed *The Indian Express*.

Hero Future likely to buy Fotowatio's solar project in India

Hero Future Energies is in talks to acquire Fotowatio Renewable Ventures's 135 megawatt (MW) solar power project in India, two people aware of the development told *Mint*. Owned by Abdul Latif Jameel Energy and Environmental Services, Fotowatio Renewables is the largest Arabian green energy utility. Its only investment in the Indian solar power space is in Andhra Pradesh. Greenstone Energy Advisors, an investment bank focussed on the Indian renewable energy sector, is managing the sale.

Kerala could become a defence manufacturing hub: Jayarajan

Kerala has accelerated the development of the defence sector by nurturing defence startups and micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and positioning the state as an industry-friendly destination with various initiatives, said industries minister E.P. Jayarajan at a recent industry meet. He also stated that one of the major initiatives by the government towards defence manufacturing is the upcoming KINFRA defence park at Ottapalam, Palakkad and the proposed aviation hub at Kannur, reported *TNN*.

CDE THA-THAS wins Product of the Year award

THA/THAS series thin pack electrolytic capacitors have been named Product of the Year in the passives category. According to *Electronic Products*, "The annual awards recognise outstanding products that represent any of the following qualities: a significant advancement in a technology or its application, an exceptionally innovative design, a substantial achievement in price/performance, improvements in design performance and a potential for new product designs/opportunities."

requirements, with China being the main source for these batteries.

Geete also said that Department of Heavy Industries has proposed customs duty cuts on parts for EVs to the finance ministry.

Investment in fibre infra is the key to India's 5G deployment: TRAI

India can be a champion in the deployment of 5G, but much hinges on

investments in fibre infrastructure, which are inadequate and trailing behind China, said R.S. Sharma, chairman of Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI).

At a recent industry meet, Sharma said that there is serious concern that while people are talking of 5G as a slogan, it would not happen unless enough effort is put into investment in fibre. He also said, merely 22 per cent of mobile towers in India are connect-

ed through fibre, unlike China, where as much as 80 per cent are on fibre.

Taiwan to set up manufacturing facilities in Gujarat

Maulik Bhansali, chairman, Gujarat Electronics and Software Industries Association (GESIA), has announced that certain technology companies of Taiwan have expressed interest in setting up manufacturing facilities in Gujarat. The Taiwanese are specifically interested in the IT, electronics and the Internet of Things (IoT) segments, he added.

Local technology firms from Gujarat and Taiwan have signed a memoranda of understanding (MoU) at Vibrant Gujarat Summit held from January 18-19, 2019. The chairman said that the companies are looking at serving local markets that have a higher IoT demand and then exporting from the planned electronics cluster to countries in the Middle East, Europe and Africa.

Andhra Pradesh targets 5GW of additional solar power capacity under new policy

Under the recently-announced Solar Policy 2018, Andhra Pradesh has set a minimum target of 5GW of newly-installed PV power capacity over the next five years. The state aims to install 18GW of renewable energy capacity by 2021-22, which will comprise 10 per cent of the country's overall target.

In a circular dated January 3, 2019, the main policy objectives of the state include developing solar parks with the necessary utility infrastructure facilities, promoting distributed generation, deploying solar-powered agricultural pump sets and promoting local manufacturing facilities—all of which will generate employment in the state.

Andhra Pradesh will initially develop 4GW of large-scale solar parks, which will include manufacturing zones as well as R&D and training centres. Meanwhile, to promote domestic manufacturing, the state plans to provide priority allotment of government-owned land on a long-term lease basis, exempt electricity duties for a period of 10 years and extend energy banking facilities for any PV projects developed by manufacturers.